

THE MOLTEN BARRICADE



AUGUST 3, 2026

I began the dream flying through a city with Silonis, the living Rainbow Crystal Sword of Life.



A band of goblins wanted to steal one of the most powerful artifacts in the Storyverse.



Their guns looked ordinary, but every bullet had been enchanted with fire magic.



Once fired, the ammunition became a flaming projectile that curved through the sky and chased me.



I could dodge the miniature fireballs while flying, so the goblins themselves felt like a distraction.



Their real threat was the gigantic troll advancing behind them with an enormous wooden club.



The troll was not skyscraper-tall, but at nearly half that height it still felt almost like a kaiju.



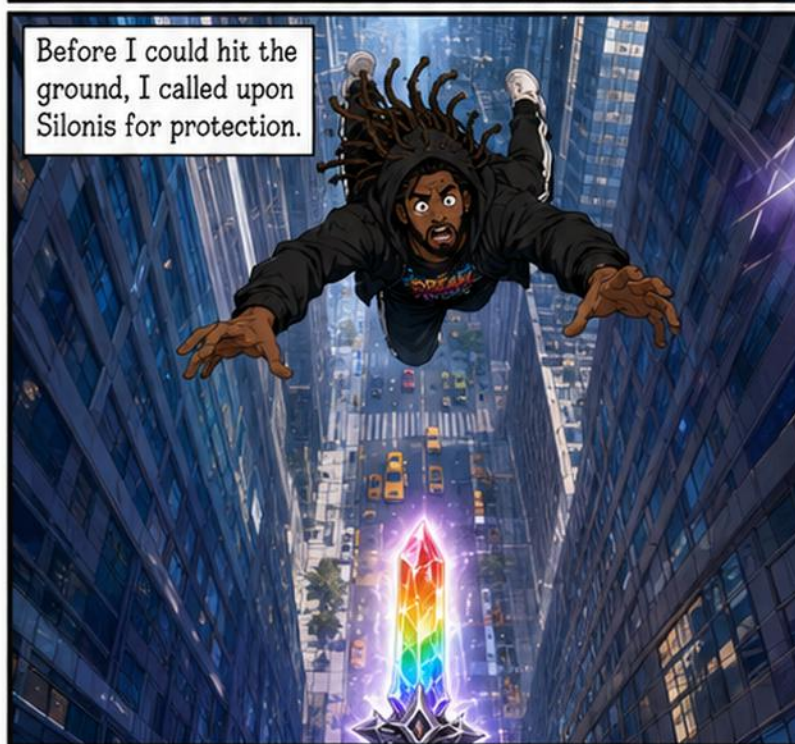
While I focused on weaving between the goblins' fire bullets, its club swept across my path.



The blow knocked me out of the sky and sent me crashing toward the street.



Before I could hit the ground, I called upon Silonis for protection.



The living sword formed a force field beneath me and softened the impact.



I was unharmed, but now I had to escape before the goblins and their troll surrounded me.





Using Lucid Light, I propelled myself forward at super speed.



The enormous troll quickly fell behind, but the goblins were fast enough to keep pace.



They continued firing enchanted bullets that curved toward me from every direction.



Fortunately, Silonis had a mind and will of its own.



The sword flew from my hand, circled me, and independently deflected every flaming projectile.



After I rounded a corner and vanished from sight, we discovered the entrance to a massive cave.

Hoping to hide from the goblins and the troll, Silonis and I ran into the cave.



Deep inside the darkness, we encountered a dragon that initially seemed friendly.



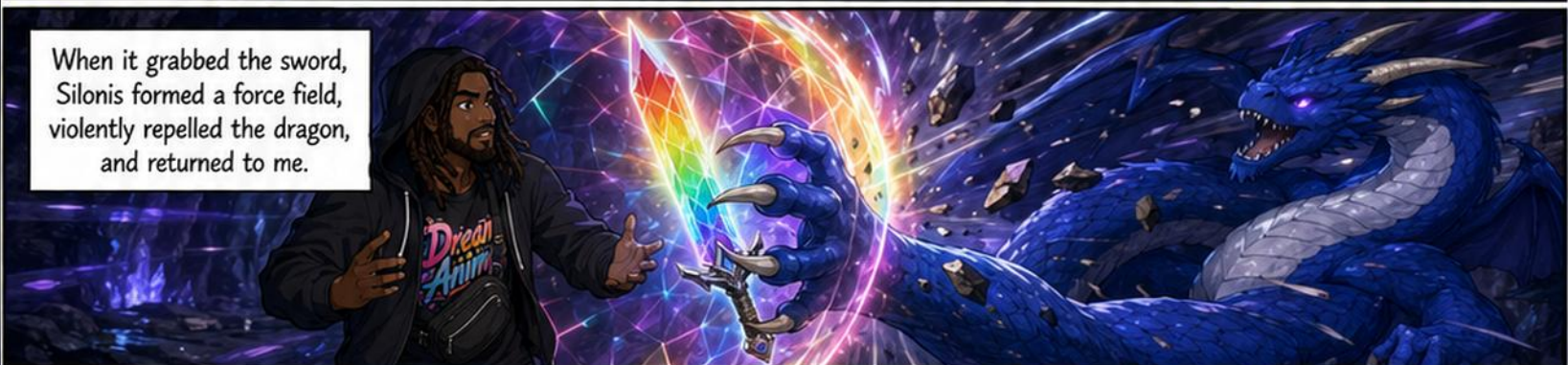
We explained that the goblins were pursuing us because they wanted the Rainbow Crystal Sword.



The dragon offered us shelter under one condition: I had to surrender Silonis.



When it grabbed the sword, Silonis formed a force field, violently repelled the dragon, and returned to me.



Angry that it could not claim the artifact, the dragon decided to betray us.



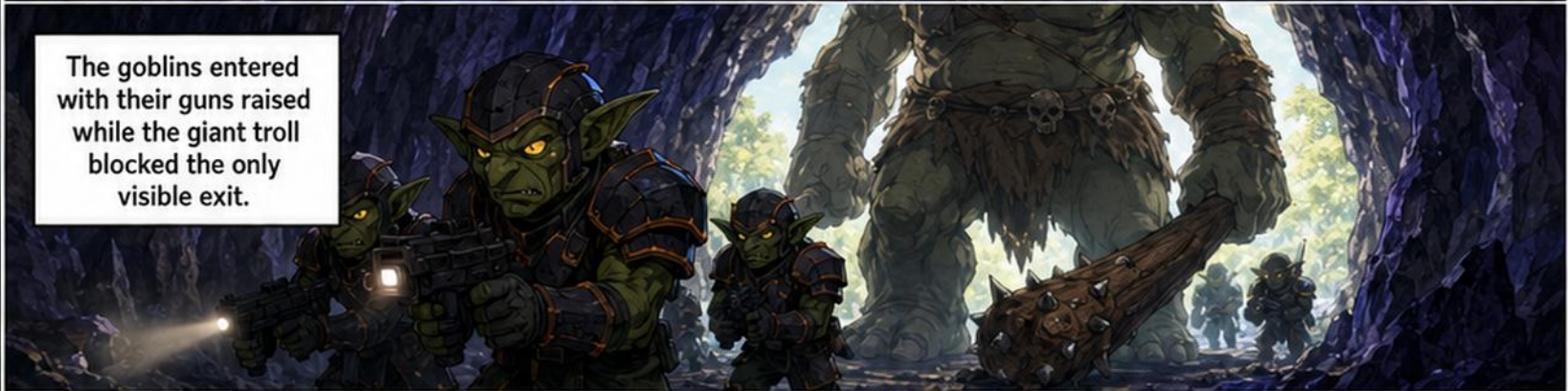
The dragon shouted toward the entrance: 'They're in here!'



Then it crawled deeper into the cave, abandoning the conflict it had created.



The goblins entered with their guns raised while the giant troll blocked the only visible exit.



Because the cavern was so dark, Silonis and I were able to hide within the shadows.



As the goblins searched, I remembered a power I had learned during one of my earliest Storyverse adventures.



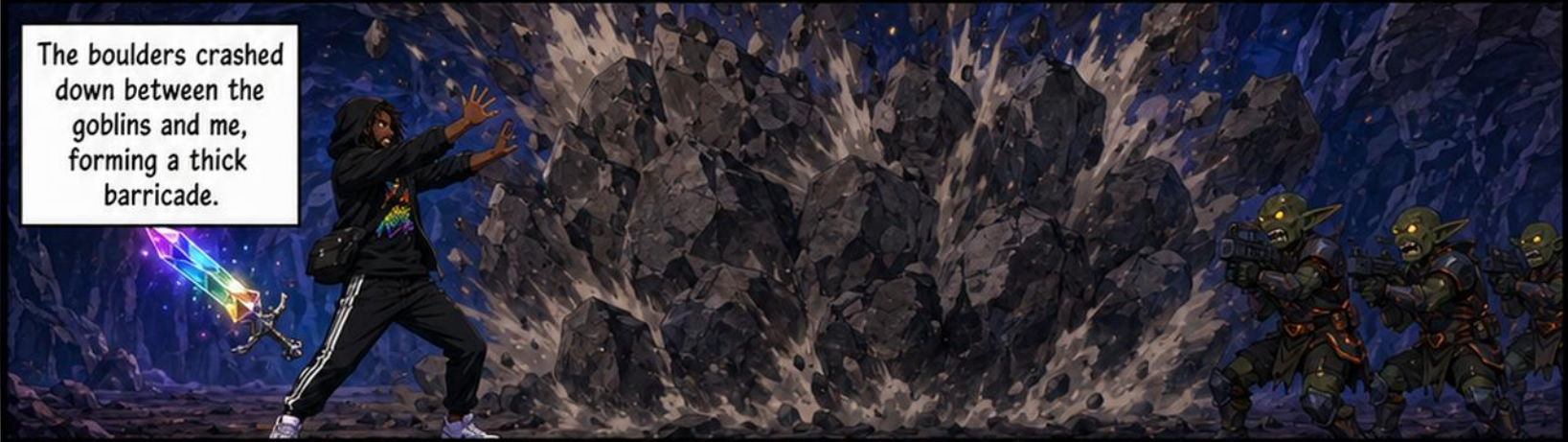
I had learned geomancy - and earth magic was perfectly suited to this trap.



I used geomancy to tear a mass of rocks from the ceiling.



The boulders crashed down between the goblins and me, forming a thick barricade.



From the opposite side, their guns hammered the wall with enchanted fire bullets.



The magic did not destroy my defense.



Its heat partially melted and welded the stones together, turning the attack into an even stronger molten barrier.



Pulling those rocks from the ceiling had also opened a skylight - a new route out of the cave.



The molten wall separated us from the goblins, and the opening above us offered freedom.



I launched upward through the skylight before the troll could react.



Silonis accelerated beside me as we climbed far beyond the cave.



Behind us, the goblins remained sealed away by the barrier their own fire had strengthened.



The slow troll and the treacherous dragon could no longer stop us.



Together, Silonis and I escaped safely into the Storyverse.

